

Council Meeting
January 10, 2024
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, January 10, 2023, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne -Via Phone
Ward II Councilor Spencer Batchelder
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Joel Tremblay
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the December 13, 2023, City Council meeting with correction to page five.

Councilor Koloski stated on page five the roll call in reference to the CDA is inaccurate, Councilor Koloski voted no.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes
Tremblay – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

City Planner deForest Bearse joined Mayor Girard for the reading of their retirement proclamation.

Filing for position of School Board will be begin on January 24, 2024 through February 2nd, 2024. Filing forms may be obtained at the SAU6 office 8:00am through 4:00pm Monday through Friday at 165 Broad Street.

On February 2, 2024 filing will be held from 3:00pm-5:00pm. Elections will be held by ballot on March 12, 2024. Positions that are open are: Moderator, Treasurer, District Clerk, and Three School Board members.

Primary Election will be held on January 23rd polls are open from 8:00am – 7:00pm, and last day for mail in ballots to be received.

January 17, 2024 last day to register in the City Clerk’s Office.

January 22, 2024 is the last day to apply for absentee ballots.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

Manager Manale announced Director Nicholas Lawrence of the Parks and Recreation Department has put in his resignation, and thanked him for his time and dedication.

Manager Manale noted the back-to-back winter storms and thanked the hard-working men and women at the DPW for their preparation and clean up of these messy storms.

Manager Manale noted at the end of 2023 the City sent out its third and fourth quarter tax bills to reflect the new tax rate. For many, the increase has been a shock. In September the re-assessment was completed which showed single and two-family residential properties increased in value by 79%, 3-family by 88%, and apartments by 129%. Commercial properties increased by 45%, and industrial by 17%. Overall, the City increased its taxable value by 62%. People moving here are now paying almost double what was asked for just a few years ago, the residential growth comes with a shift on the tax burden. Residential properties increased at a higher rate than commercial and industrial it took on a more significant percentage of the overall tax burden on the City. The tax rate is divided – The City share is 37%, the County is 8%, and combined school/state is 55%. In the past year the City increased 5%, the County increased 15%, and the School/State increased 10%. When the tax rate was set inflation at this time was about 6.1%.

Manager Manale introduced Finance Director Mulholland, Assessor Hamilton, and City Clerk Gwen Melcher to answer any questions the Council may have regarding the tax bill and tax rate, Manager Manale also noted the company Vision, a third party which was contracted to do the assessment will be here on the 24th to explain how they determined the re-assessed value.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Steering Committee for the EPA Multi-Purpose Grant

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to Appoint Elyse Crossman to Seat 6 of the Steering Committee for the EPA Multi-Purpose Grant.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay –yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Batchelder – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to Appoint Dana McGrath to Seat 5 of the Steering Committee for the EPA Multi-Purpose Grant.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay –yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Batchelder – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to Appoint Sophia Sushailo to Seat 4 of the Steering Committee for the EPA Multi-Purpose Grant.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O'Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to Appoint David Putnam as the Planning Board Representative for the Steering Committee for the EPA Multi-Purpose Grant.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O'Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to Appoint Eric Ruffin as the Conservation Commission Representative for the Steering Committee for the EPA Multi-Purpose Grant.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes

**Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

Policy Committee

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to Re-appoint Bonnie Miles to Seat 5 of the Policy Committee.

**Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Jonathan F. Stone to Seat 4 of the Policy Committee.

**Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

Claremont Police Commission

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked if the candidates could speak if they are at the meeting.

Councilor Koloski stated he has an issue with this because the candidates were not notified of this opportunity.

Councilor Batchelder agreed and suggested tabling the appointment where the candidate could speak.

Councilor Hemingway also agreed to table the appointment and suggested sending a letter to the candidates.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Hayden to re-appoint John Hall to Seat 1 of the Claremont Police Commission.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to appoint Mark Limoges to Seat 1 of the Claremont Police Commission.

Mayor Girard allowed both nominated candidates John Hall, and Mark Limoges to Speak.

Roll call:

Koloski – Hall

Tremblay –Hall

Limoges - Limoges

Matteau – Hall

Batchelder – Limoges

Hemingway – Limoges

Hayden – Hall

O’Hearne – Limoges

Girard – Hall

Motion carried 5-4 in favor of John Hall.

Zoning Board of Adjustment

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to appoint Aran LaFontaine to Seat A1 of the Zoning Board of Adjustment.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay –yes

Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Council Seats

Airport Advisory Board

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to appoint Mayor Girard to the Airport Advisory Board.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

CCTV

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to appoint Mayor Girard to the CCTV Board.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Planning Board

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to appoint Assistant Mayor Matteau to the Planning Board.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to appoint Councilor Koloski as an alternate seat on the Planning Board.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Conservation Commission

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to appoint Councilor Batchelder to the Conservation Commission.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes

Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Historic District Commission

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to appoint Councilor Tremblay to the Historic District Commission.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Policy Committee

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hayden to appoint Councilor Limoges, Councilor Hemingway, and Councilor Batchelder to the Policy Committee.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay –yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – no
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-1

EPA Steering Committee

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to appoint Councilor Hayden to the EPA Steering Committee.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay –yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Batchelder – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Mayor Girard asked for a new Sargent in Arms, Councilor Batchelder agreed.

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mayor Girard reminded all that each person has a five-minute limit on non-agenda items.

Mike Tetu, Ward I, shared concern for Section 25 of the Council rules, stating the CDA item was not filed with the clerk, and section 47 which permits citizens to speak to agenda items after being introduced and noted this is something the Council hasn’t been doing. Mr. Tetu stated Mr. Sullivan contacted the LNWCF, and they are not aware of the non-park retail use agreement between City and bike business. Mr. Tetu also shared concern for the transfer station.

Mark Chamberlain, Ward 1, noted he was retired and had time on hands and after hearing chatter about the taxes he wanted to do his own investigation. Mr. Chamberlain shared his findings and noted there is a lot of information that needs to be shared because many people don’t understand what’s happening with their taxes and transparency is better than misinformation.

Clinton Lawry, Ward 2, stated he was not happy with the recent tax increase, and has lived here for 50 years and gone through many property reassessments. The most recent one is over the top and noted his increase went up 25.2%. Mr. Lawry stated many are frustrated and feels as though the City is not listening to them. Mr. Lawry stated this was an unfair appraisal and big businesses got a reduction in taxes, and asked what about the hard-working home owners and noted many families are struggling for food, car expenses, and housing. Mr. Lawry brought up those who are on fixed incomes, and stated some may think its good for Claremont to have a lower commercial rate but it hurts the working class of Claremont.

Jack Paluchick, Ward 1, Works with Eversource and is the new contact with municipalities, and noted he himself took advantage of Eversource programs to save money on energy costs, and encouraged all to do the same especially now with the tax increase.

Hope Damon, District 8 State Representative, gave an update on house bills that were passed and failed.

Jon Stone, State Representative, Ward III- noted it is imperative to see what the City can have influence over relative to the school board budget.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 619

City Planner Bearse, explained Ordinance 619 and noted this was back for its second and final reading.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-THREE

ORDINANCE #619

ZONING ORDINANCE AMENDMENTS SIGNS IN THE HISTORIC DISTRICT

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to RSA 675:2 and RSA 674:16, Chapter 22, Zoning, of the Claremont City Code is hereby amended as follows:

Section 1. Signs in the Historic District.

Amend Section 22-604 by adding a new Sec. 22-604(8) to streamline the process for new signs in the Historic District by exempting such signs from the need to obtain a Certificate of Appropriateness if they meet specific standards, reading as follows:

Sec. 22-604(8). In the Historic District.

Signs that comply with the following design standards will not be required to obtain a Certificate of Appropriateness as would otherwise be required under Sec 22-405(4).

The total number of signs and their total allowed square footage shall comply with the underlying zoning district except where specifically limited by the requirements below.

a. General

1. Wood and metal signs are preferred.

Two types of signs are allowed in the Historic District – affixed and freestanding.

b. Affixed signage in the historic district may be in the form of:

1. Blade or projecting signs:
 - Blade or projecting signs shall:
 - be limited to the first and second stories of a building only.
 - be attached to the building at right angles to the building face.
 - have attached, painted or engraved lettering.
 - have a maximum area of 12 square feet each.
 - not project above the roof or cornice line of the building.
 - clear sidewalks by a height of at least eight (8) feet above ground level.
 - be centered over or located near the principal doorway to the building.
 - not be located at building corners where they do not meet perpendicular to the building façade.
2. Signage that is attached parallel to the building face:
 - This type of signage shall be located within the existing sign banner of the building, if one exists.
 - If no banner exists, the signage shall be located above the main entrance door and windows of the store face and shall not cover any architectural details.
3. Lettering on storefront window or awning:
 - If an awning exists, affixed signage may consist of lettering printed on the awning fringe.
 - Window lettering shall be painted on or of applied vinyl.
 - Whenever possible, window signs should be located on the window beside the primary business entrance.
 - Permanent window signs may be painted on or affixed to the inside of one window of the business but may cover no more than 25% of the total window area located on the front of the building.
 - Additional information may be placed on the window of the entrance door of the business.

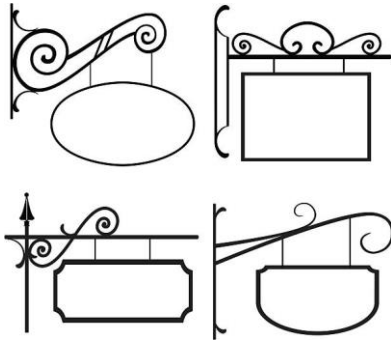


Figure 1: Affixed blade signs



Figure 2: Affixed Sign within Sign Banner

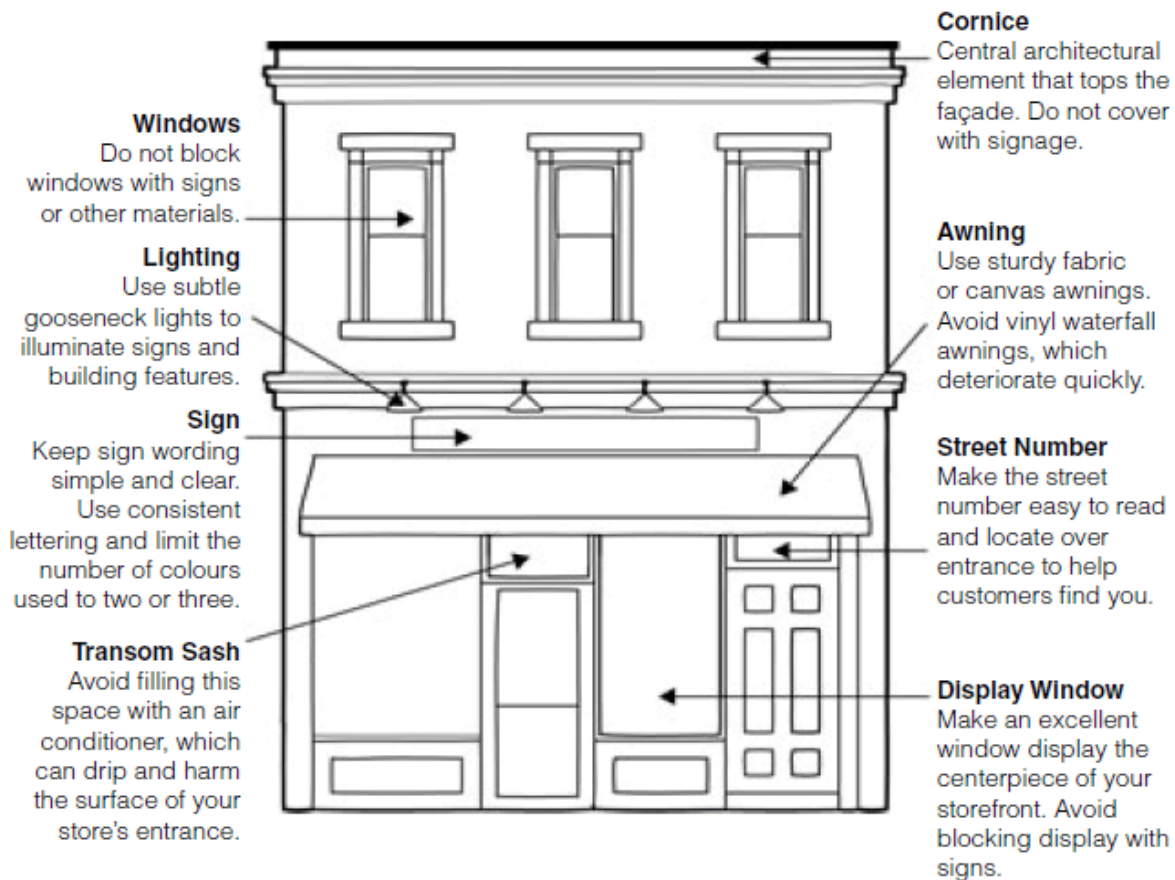
c. Freestanding Signs

1. No such sign shall exceed five (5) feet in height from ground level to the top of the sign.
2. The total area shall not exceed the underlying zoning district maximum.
3. No freestanding sign shall be located closer than:
 - a. four (4) feet to any street right-of-way,
 - b. four (4) feet of any side property line or
 - c. fifty (50) feet of any dwelling.
4. No freestanding sign shall obstruct driver visibility.
5. Whenever possible and without obstructing driver visibility, freestanding signs shall be incorporated in a hedge or landscaping feature.

d. Sign Lighting

1. Wall mounted and goose-neck fixtures are appropriate for lighting signs that are parallel to the building face.
2. Blade signs may have directional pendant lighting.
3. A ceiling mounted fixture may illuminate recessed entries.
4. Neon lights and internally-lit signs are not permitted.

e. Architectural features for signs in the historic district: see diagram below.



Amend Section 22-406 to add a new Sec. 22-406(5) exempting new signs in the historic district that comply fully with the standards in 22-604(8), as follows:

Sec. 22-406. - Exceptions.

The historic district commission is not required to review the following activities:

- (1) Ordinary maintenance and repair of any architectural feature which does not involve a change in the design, materials or outer appearance or involve removal thereof.
- (2) Painting or repainting of a wood surface and/or an already painted masonry surface.
- (3) Roofing or reroofing (with the same material) of a building or structure providing the roof plane remains the same.
- (4) Storm doors and storm windows providing that the original architectural features are not removed or destroyed.
- (5) Signs fully complying with the standards in Sec 22-604(8).

Amend Section 22-596 to eliminate the need for a Certificate of Appropriateness for new signs in the Historic District if they meet standards of Section 22-604(8) as follows:

Sec. 22-596. Permit required.

- (a) No sign shall be placed, erected, moved, replaced, or reconstructed without a permit unless specifically exempted in this chapter. Such permit shall be issued by the zoning administrator provided the sign meets all the requirements of this chapter. Applications for a sign permit shall be made to the zoning administrator on the form provided by him and shall include a set of plans (to scale), showing site location, sign size, colors, the design, type and size of lettering, method of illumination (if any), and the type of materials to be used in construction.
- (b) All signs requiring a permit and signs permitted by section 22-603(7) and (9) that are to be located within the historic zoning district shall be subject to the provisions of section 22-397 et seq. and section 22-604(8).

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 22 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Councilor Koloski to adopt Ordinance 619.

Councilor Batchelder Read Explanation of proposed action into record.

Mayor Girard opened up a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2023-37 NH Highway Safety

Chief Wilmot welcomed the three new Councilors, and then stated he is seeking acceptance for the NH Highway Safety Grant, which is something that is done yearly.

RESOLUTION 2023-37

NEW HAMPSHIRE HIGHWAY SAFETY GRANT

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has applied for and been awarded a New Hampshire Highway Safety Grant for various motor vehicle enforcement activities in the amount of \$9,300 for the period ending September 30, 2024; and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend the funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to accept the Highway Safety Grant Funds in the amount of \$9,300 from the NH Highway Safety Agency for the purpose of motor vehicle enforcement (with no impact to the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 10th day of January, 2024 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2023-37.

Councilor Batchelder read the Resolution into the record.

Mayor Girard opened up a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Batchelder – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2024-20 Repurposing of the 2021

Finance Director Mulholland Explained Resolution 2024-20, and stated the bond has been untouched for three years and it needs to be spent or else the City will face arbitrage federal penalties, and suggested using it for one of our CIP projects, specifically the elevators.

After discussion the Council wants more clarity and would like this to come back at the next meeting.

RESOLUTION 2024-20

Reallocation of Communications Dispatch Center Bond Principal

WHEREAS, the City of Claremont, New Hampshire (the “City”) issued a 2021 General Obligation Bond on 01/06/2021 in the principal amount of \$1,000,000 (the “2021 Bond”) to finance equipment for and improvements to the Communications Dispatch Center (the “2021 Project”) pursuant to City Council Resolution 2021-9;

WHEREAS, the City anticipates receiving federal and/or state funding to complete the 2021 Project and so has not proceeded to expend the 2021 Bond;

WHEREAS, there currently remains \$843,279 of unspent principal of the 2021 Bond;

WHEREAS, the City Council recognizes an urgent need to repurpose the unspent 2021 Bond proceeds, and to use unspent principal towards the next debt service payment;

NOW THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, acting under and pursuant to the City Charter, including Section 49 therein, and the laws of the State of New Hampshire including RSA Chapter 33:3-a, that:

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED The City is authorized to repurpose \$843,279 of unspent principal from the 2021 Bond (the “Repurposed Principal”), to finance costs to acquire and install two elevators located at City Hall (the “Project”), which costs were originally included in the City’s 2024 capital budget;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED The Repurposed Principal are appropriated to provide for costs of the Project; (with no impact to the tax rate)

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED In all other respects, the provisions of Resolution 2021-9 remain valid and in full force and effect as if incorporated herein;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED The Treasurer, City Manager, Clerk, and other proper officials of the City are authorized and empowered in its name and on its behalf to do or cause to be done all such acts and things, not inconsistent herewith, as may be necessary or desirable in order to effect the accomplishment of the Project herein authorized;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED The City is further authorized to appropriate unspent 2021 Bond principal to make the upcoming debt service payment on the 2021 Bond, due no later than February 15, 2024, and to remove that expense from the current water, sewer, and general budgetary lines so that it is treated instead as an expense against the Project;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED The Clerk is authorized and directed to file an attested copy of this Resolution in the record of proceedings of the City Council, which record shall be open to public inspection; and All prior actions undertaken by the City consistent with this Resolution are hereby confirmed, ratified and approved.

(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 10th day of January, 2024 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to table Resolution 2024-20 to the next Council Meeting January 24, 2024.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes
Tremblay – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Batchelder – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Vehicles and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund

Memorandum

To: Yoshi Manale, City Manager
From: Alex Gleeson, Director of Public Works
Date: 2024-01-10
Re: Establishing Non-Capital Reserve Funds

The Department of Public works would like to establish a non-capital reserve fund for the Highway Department, Sewer Department, and Water Department in order to utilize the money that is a result of the sale of older equipment. This is equipment would be at the end of its useful life or is beyond reasonable repair costs to justify the cities needs to continue owning it. The department would use 100% of sales of retired vehicles and equipment for these non-capital funds.

The objective of this would allow for off-setting the cost or fully funding future equipment and vehicle needs within the three departments separate from new loans/leases or new money moving forward.

Resolution 2024-21 DPW Vehicles and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund

Director Mulholland explained that this was a directive from the last council meeting to set up these non-capital reserve funds.

Councilor Koloski stated this is something he has been pushing, and suggested this be a practice with all departments.

RESOLUTION 2024-21

Department of Public Works Vehicles and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a non-capital reserve for the Department of Public Works for the downpayment or purchasing of vehicles and equipment in Claremont; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish a non-capital reserve fund for the Department of Public Works Vehicles and Equipment would come from up to 100% of sales of retired vehicles and equipment; and

NOW THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that pursuant to RSA 34:1-a, the City of Claremont hereby establishes a reserve fund to be known as Non-Capital Reserve Fund for Department of Public Works Vehicles and Equipment for the purpose of purchase and replacing vehicles and equipment in Claremont; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees will cause up to 100% of sales of retired vehicles and equipment received and will be deposited into the Department of Public Works Vehicle and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund Account;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(Majority Vote Required)

Dated this 10th day of January, 2024, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2024-21

Councilor Batchelder Read the Resolution into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Batchelder – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2024-22 Water Department Vehicles and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund

RESOLUTION 2024-22

Water Department Vehicles and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a non-capital reserve for the Water Department for the downpayment or purchasing of vehicles and equipment in Claremont; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish a non-capital reserve fund for the Water Department Vehicles and Equipment would come from up to 100% of sales of retired vehicles and equipment; and

NOW THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that pursuant to RSA 34:1-a, the City of Claremont hereby establishes a reserve fund to be known as Non-Capital Reserve Fund for Water Department Vehicles and Equipment for the purpose of purchase and replacing vehicles and equipment in Claremont; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees will cause up to 100% of sales of retired vehicles and equipment received and will be deposited into the Water Department Vehicle and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund Account;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(Majority Vote Required)

Dated this 10th day of January, 2024, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to accept Resolution 2024-22.

Councilor Limoges Read the Resolution into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Batchelder – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2024-2323 Sewer Department Vehicles and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund

RESOLUTION 2024-23

Sewer Department Vehicles and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a non-capital reserve for the Sewer Department for the downpayment or purchasing of vehicles and equipment in Claremont; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish a non-capital reserve fund for the Sewer Department Vehicles and Equipment would come from up to 100% of sales of retired vehicles and equipment; and

NOW THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that pursuant to RSA 34:1-a, the City of Claremont hereby establishes a reserve fund to be known as Non-Capital Reserve Fund for Sewer Department Vehicles and Equipment for the purpose of purchase and replacing vehicles and equipment in Claremont; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees will cause up to 100% of sales of retired vehicles and equipment received and will be deposited into the Sewer Department Vehicle and Equipment Non-Capital Reserve Fund Account;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(Majority Vote Required)

Dated this 10th day of January, 2024, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2024-23.

Councilor Koloski Read the Resolution into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Batchelder – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the Planning Board met Monday night. The Planning Board discussed the CIP plan and will come back for a public hearing, and also discussed Airbnb’s.

Councilor Koloski noted cottage courts, and Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the square footage was amended and will come back to Council.

Councilor Batchelder noted there will be a Presentation on windfarm monitoring.

Councilor Limoges noted the policy committee mostly reviewed the past year.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Assistant Mayor Matteau wants to peruse Mr. Stone's idea and gather more information on what authority the City Council can have over School spending.

Assistant Mayor Matteau brought up elderly exemptions, and wants an analysis on how the re-assessment affected those who have an elderly exemption and if that needs to be adjusted again, as well as the veteran's exemption. Manager Manale stated this has been addressed with Assessing to start this process and plans to come to Council in April.

Councilor Koloski wants to add the dispatch center into the CIP.
Manager Manale noted police items in past have not been added into the CIP but the plan is to change this for the future, and will meet with the Planning Department to make sure it is included.

Councilor Koloski also asked to establish a master plan committee.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:44 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to adjourn.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay –yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Batchelder – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council